A FLUENCY CHALLENGE

TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Simplification, Paraphrasing, and Adaptation

HOW TO PLAY

1. Read the **modern concept** shown on the card.

2. Look at the **target audience** (someone who has zero context of our modern world).

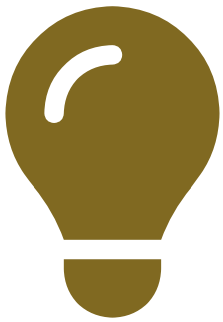
3. Explain the concept in exactly **2 minutes**, using simple synonyms and analogies.

4. Make sure your examples fit into their historical world!

YOUR LINGUISTIC TOOLBOX

Phrases for Simplifying and Comparing:

- *The simplest way to put it is...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *Imagine that in your world, you had...*
- *Think of it as a virtual version of...*
- *Essentially, it serves as...*
- *In other words, it allows people to...*



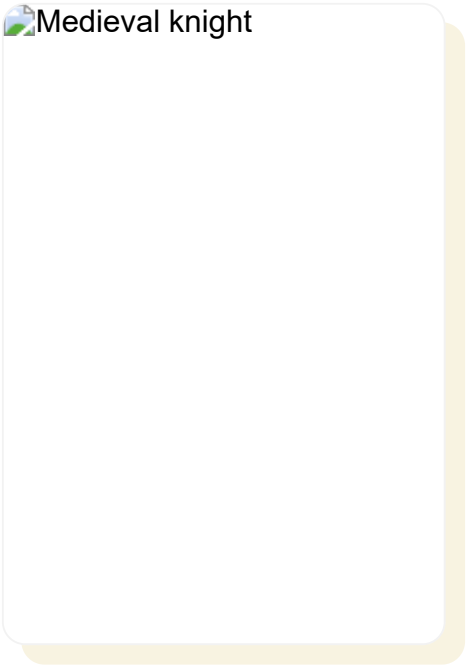
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS SOCIAL MEDIA?

EXPLAIN IT TO A MEDIEVAL KNIGHT.

- *I'd say it's basically...*
- *Imagine that...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *Think of it as...*



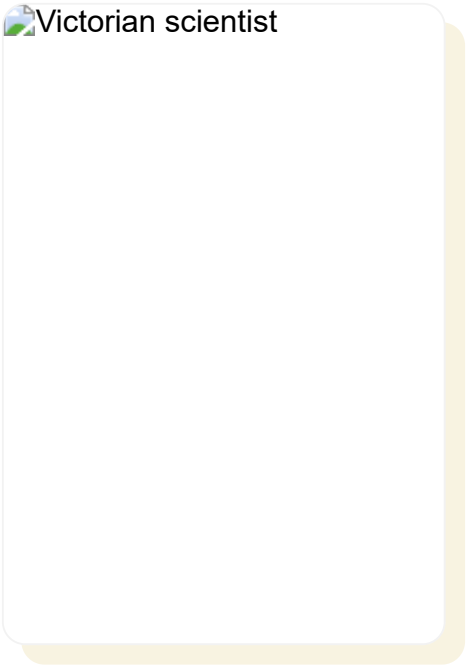
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS THE INTERNET?

EXPLAIN IT TO A VICTORIAN SCIENTIST.

- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *In other words...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *Imagine that...*



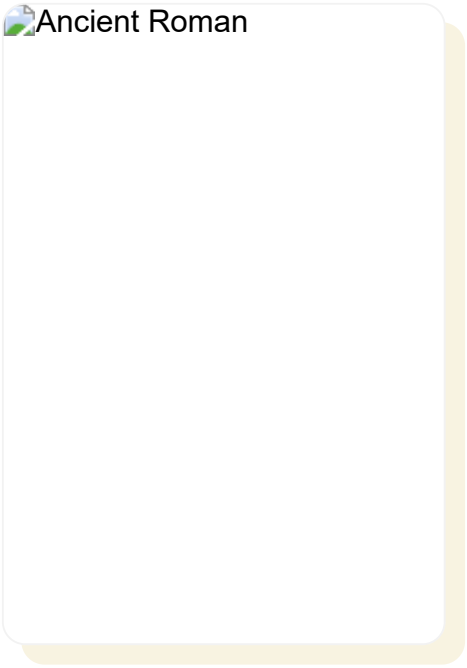
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS A SMARTPHONE?

EXPLAIN IT TO AN ANCIENT ROMAN.

- *Think of it as...*
- *I'd say it's basically...*
- *Imagine that...*
- *In other words...*



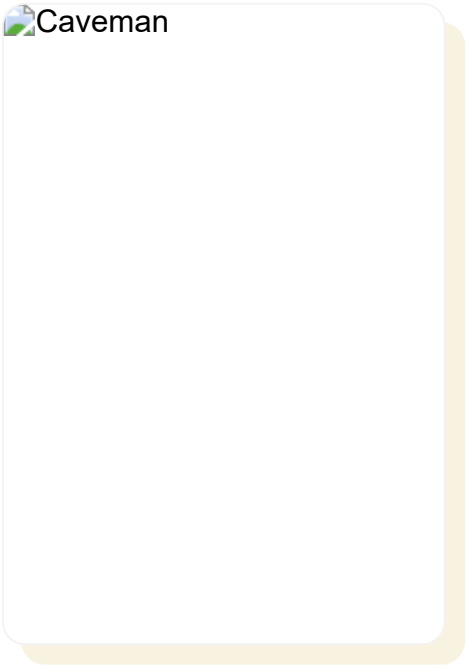
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS ELECTRICITY?

EXPLAIN IT TO A CAVEMAN.

- *It's kind of like...*
- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *Imagine that...*
- *Think of it as...*



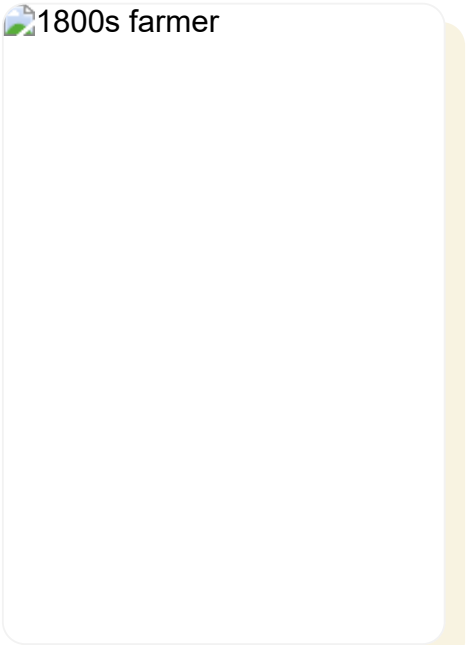
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE?

EXPLAIN IT TO A FARMER IN 1800.

- *I'd say it's basically...*
- *In other words...*
- *Imagine that...*
- *Think of it as...*



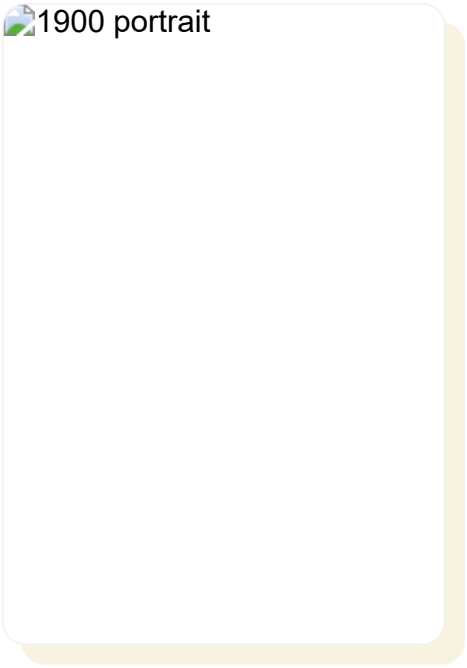
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS CLIMATE CHANGE?

EXPLAIN IT TO A PERSON IN 1900.

- *Imagine that...*
- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *Think of it as...*



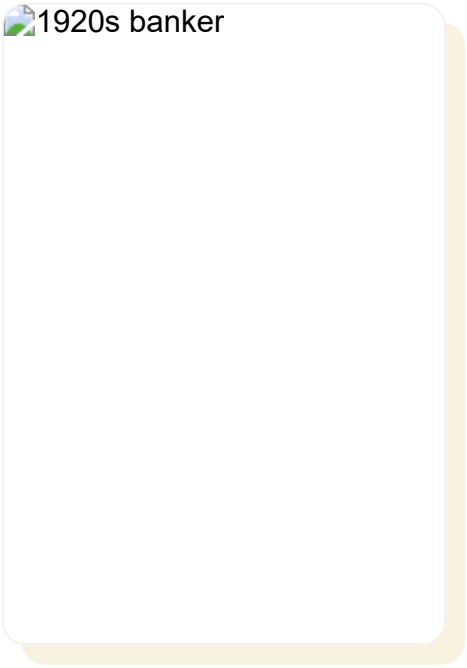
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS BITCOIN?

EXPLAIN IT TO A 1920S BANKER.

- *Think of it as...*
- *In other words...*
- *I'd say it's basically...*
- *It's kind of like...*



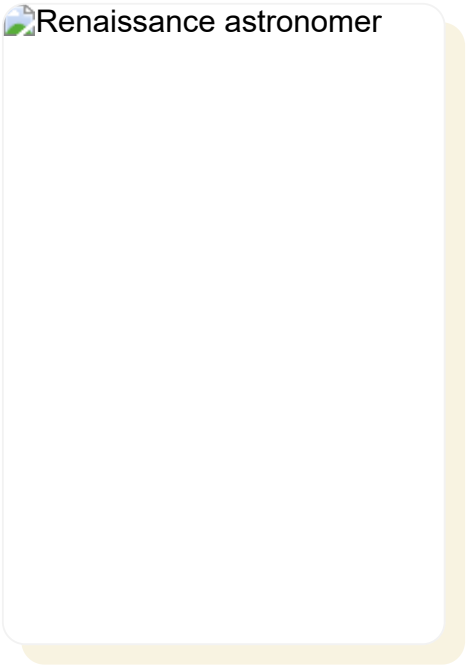
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS SPACE TRAVEL?

EXPLAIN TO A RENAISSANCE ASTRONOMER.

- *Imagine that...*
- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *Think of it as...*
- *In other words...*



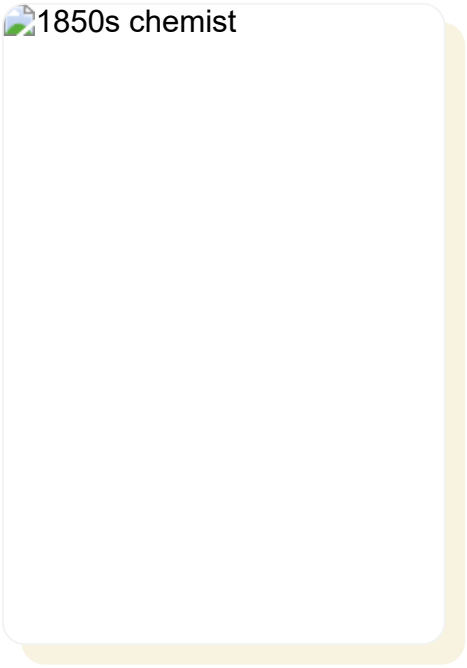
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS DNA?

EXPLAIN IT TO AN 1850S CHEMIST.

- *I'd say it's basically...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *Think of it as...*



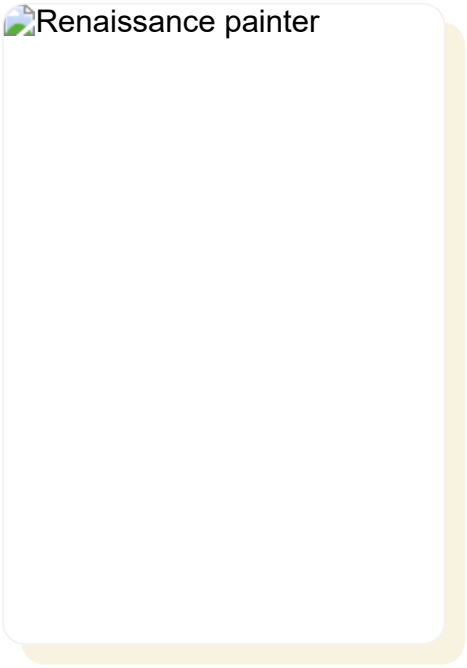
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT ARE VIDEO GAMES?

EXPLAIN IT TO A PAINTER IN 1600.

- *Imagine that...*
- *Think of it as...*
- *In other words...*
- *It's kind of like...*



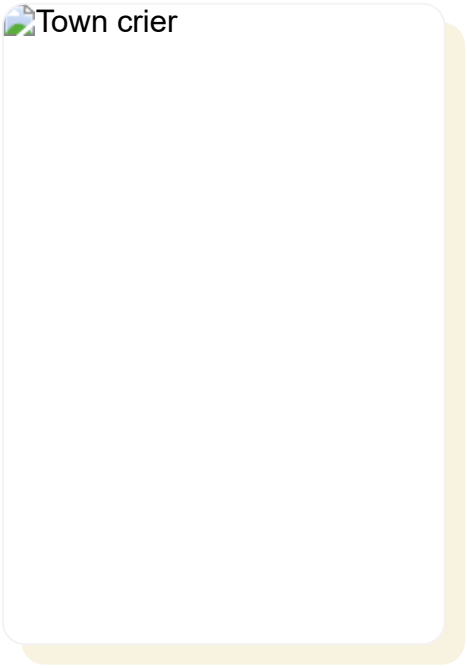
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT ARE PODCASTS?

EXPLAIN TO A 1500S TOWN CRIER.

- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *Think of it as...*
- *In other words...*
- *Imagine that...*



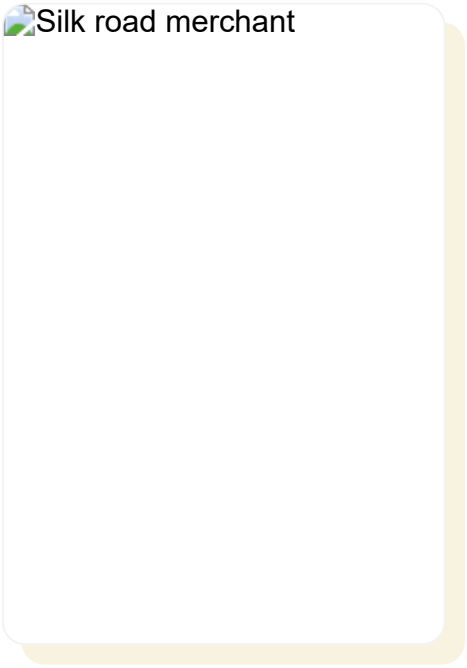
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS ONLINE SHOPPING?

EXPLAIN TO A SILK ROAD MERCHANT.

- *Imagine that...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *Think of it as...*
- *In other words...*



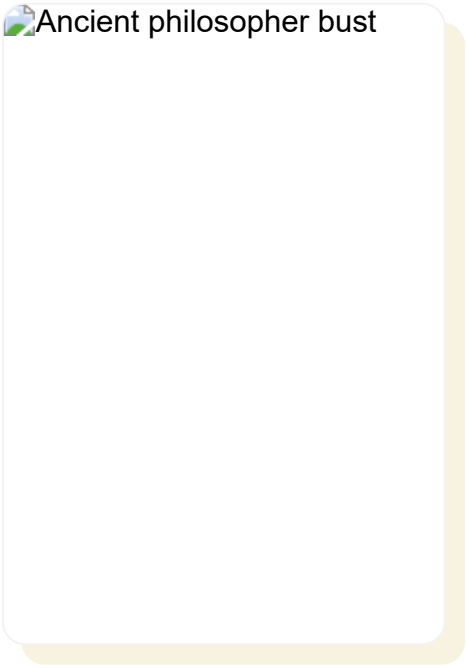
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS MENTAL HEALTH?

EXPLAIN TO AN ANCIENT PHILOSOPHER.

- *I'd say it's basically...*
- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *In other words...*
- *Imagine that...*



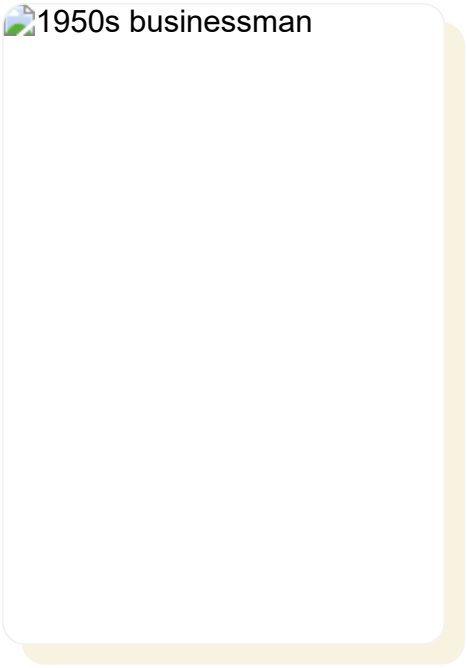
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS YOGA?

EXPLAIN TO A 1950S BUSINESSMAN.

- *Think of it as...*
- *Imagine that...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *In other words...*



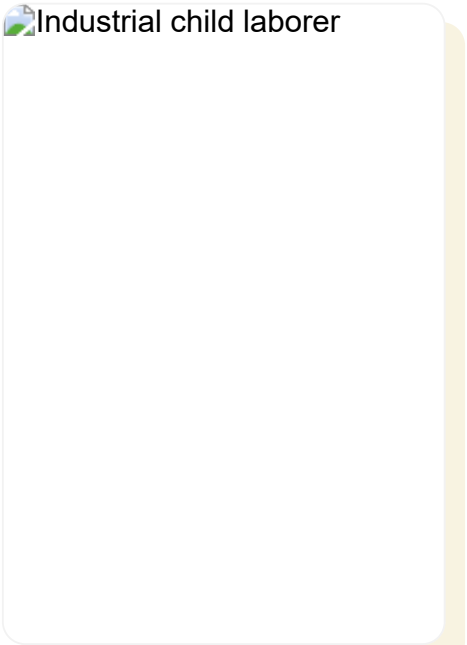
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS WORK-LIFE BALANCE?

EXPLAIN TO AN 1880S CHILD LABORER.

- *I'd say it's basically...*
- *Imagine that...*
- *Think of it as...*
- *In other words...*



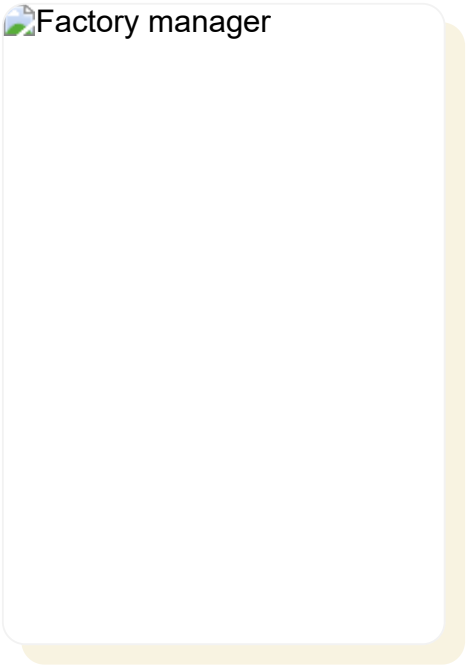
TEACH ME IN 2 MINUTES

Read the card and explain the thing on it in the way described.

WHAT IS REMOTE WORK?

EXPLAIN TO A 1920S FACTORY MANAGER.

- *The simplest way to explain it is...*
- *It's kind of like...*
- *Imagine that...*
- *In other words...*



DISCUSSION & REFLECTION

Which concept was the hardest to simplify? Why?

What analogies worked best for your target audience?

How does simplifying help you understand a topic better?